

21 Questions To Ask At Your Next Oncology Appointment

A calm, practical checklist you can print or keep on your phone.
Designed by patients, caregivers and clinicians.

It is completely normal to forget questions during an oncology appointment. Stress, emotion and information overload make it hard to think clearly in the moment. This checklist gives you 21 questions you can bring with you - tick the ones that matter most, and add your own at the end.

Understanding My Diagnosis

- ☐ What type of cancer do I have, and where did it start?
- ☐ What is the stage and grade of my cancer?
- ☐ Has the cancer spread to other parts of my body?
- ☐ Can you explain my pathology report in plain language?
- ☐ What does this diagnosis mean for my daily life right now?

Understanding My Treatment

- ☐ What are my treatment options?
- ☐ Why do you recommend this particular treatment for me?
- ☐ What is the goal of treatment - cure, control, or symptom relief?
- ☐ What are the most common side effects, and how can I manage them?
- ☐ How long will treatment last, and how often will I need to come in?
- ☐ Are there clinical trials I should consider?

Daily Life During Treatment

- ☐ Can I continue working during treatment?
- ☐ What symptoms should I report to you immediately?
- ☐ Are there activities, foods or medications I should avoid?
- ☐ What support services are available to me (counselling, nutrition, physiotherapy)?
- ☐ Who should I call if I feel unwell outside of appointments?

Preparing For My Next Appointment

- ☐ What should I track or write down between now and my next visit?
- ☐ When is my next appointment, and what will happen at it?
- ☐

What questions should I bring next time?

- ☐ Is there anything I can do now to prepare for the next stage of treatment?
- ☐ Who else should be involved in my care conversations (family, GP, nurse)?

My Own Questions

Write your own questions here before your appointment:

This checklist does not replace medical advice. It helps you prepare for conversations with your care team. For more support, visit myhealthcanvas.com